At diplomatic missions abroad, the threat of information leaks and defections was real. Sometime in mid-1950, the government issued instructions to keep information under lock and key. It also issued a top-secret note warning officers against slips in handling secret files. The note said:

Instances have come to notice where top-secret documents have been lost or mislaid and also where certain documents have been destroyed by heads of missions without the knowledge of the government of India. This is irregular. In some cases, heads of missions or posts have taken away top secret or other classified documents on the grounds that the documents in question were addressed to them by name. It may be added, in this connection, that if an occasion arises when an officer feels that a document cannot be left with the person temporarily taking over from him, he should obtain government orders beforehand for the disposal of such documents. Under no circumstances can an officer take away secret or other classified documents with him.

It was considered the duty of every spy and individual government servant handling state secrets to ensure their safety, prevent them from falling into the hands of unauthorised people and ensure that their contents were not disclosed to anyone. Unless every person employed in clandestine work made the utmost effort to protect classified documents and information, it would be impossible to prevent leaks.

According to the R&AW spies, there are three possible reasons for a spy to become a double agent. The first motive for defection and betraying the country is monetary gain. Ideology, such as a certain political affiliation, is another reason. And